

MINI PROJECT

Market Analysis & Competitive Intelligence Report

Product Management with AI | Batch 02

Course Product Management with AI

Objective Learn how product managers analyze a company's product, market positioning, and digital strategy using publicly available data and AI-assisted research tools.

Background

Product managers must understand not only their own product but also the **market environment in which the product operates**. This includes understanding:

- the company's **product strategy**
- its **digital presence**
- its **market positioning**
- its **growth strategy**

With the availability of digital intelligence tools and AI assistants, it is now possible to conduct **deep market and product analysis using publicly available information**.

In this assignment, each group will conduct a **comprehensive analysis of a single company**, similar to how a **product manager or strategy team would analyze their own company or a potential acquisition target**.

Task

Each group must select **one company in the technology or digital product space** and prepare a **comprehensive market and product intelligence report**.

Primary Focus

Understanding the chosen company in depth. Towards the end of the analysis, briefly explore **other players in the same segment** to understand the broader competitive landscape.

Step 1 Select a Company

Choose **one company operating in the tech / product ecosystem**. Examples include:

- **SaaS companies** Notion, Slack, Airtable
- **AI companies** Anthropic, Perplexity, Cohere
- **Developer tools**
- **Fintech platforms**
- **Product-led startups**
- **Digital consumer apps**

Avoid extremely large companies where the analysis becomes too broad. The goal is to study a product-led company where the product strategy is clearly visible.

Step 2 Company Background

Identify and analyze (not limited to):

- Founding year
- Founders and leadership team
- Funding history (if applicable)
- Business model
- Revenue model
- Geographic focus
- Target customers

Step 3 Product and Value Proposition

Analyze the company's **core product offering**. Identify:

- The primary product
- The problem the product solves
- The value proposition
- Product positioning
- Pricing model
- Feature differentiation

Questions to answer

- What is the **core job-to-be-done** for users?
- Who is the **target user segment**?
- What makes the product **distinctive in the market**?

Step 4 Digital Strategy Analysis

Analyze the company's **digital presence and customer acquisition strategy**. Areas to explore:

- Website traffic patterns
- Major traffic sources
- Organic vs paid traffic
- SEO and keyword strategy
- Content marketing strategy
- Social media presence
- Partnerships or integrations

The goal is to understand **how the company acquires and engages users online**.

Step 5 Product Ecosystem and Growth Strategy

Analyze how the company expands and sustains its product. Consider:

- Product roadmap signals
- Integrations and partnerships
- Ecosystem strategy
- Platform strategy (if any)
- Developer or API ecosystem
- Community building

Questions to explore

- How is the company **expanding its product footprint**?
- What signals indicate **future growth direction**?

Step 6 Market Segment and Other Players

Once the company analysis is complete, briefly examine the **broader segment** in which the company operates. Identify:

- 3–5 other companies in the same segment
- Their positioning
- How they differ from the focal company

You are **not expected to do deep analysis of competitors**, but should demonstrate awareness of the **market landscape**. Create a **simple competitor comparison table**, for example:

Company	Positioning	Key Difference
Focal Company	...	...
Competitor A	...	...
Competitor B	...	...

Step 7 Product Manager Perspective

Each group must answer:

If you were a **Product Manager at this company**, what strategic recommendations would you make?

Examples:

- New features
- Product expansion
- Pricing changes
- New user segments
- Improvements in digital acquisition
- Ecosystem development

This section should demonstrate **product thinking**.

Step 8 AI Workflow Documentation

Document **how you used AI tools during the analysis**. Include:

- Prompts used
- Tasks AI helped with
- Limitations or errors encountered

This demonstrates **AI-assisted research capability**.

Tools for Competitive Intelligence & Digital Analysis

Use the following tools (free versions) to conduct your analysis, as discussed in class.

1. SimilarWeb

Analyze:

- Website traffic

- Traffic sources
- Audience geography
- Engagement metrics

2. SpyFu

Analyze:

- Competitor keywords
- Paid search strategy
- Organic search performance

3. Diffbot

Use Diffbot or AI scraping tools to extract:

- Company information
- Product information
- Structured insights

4. SEMrush (free features)

Analyze:

- SEO keywords
- Top pages
- Organic search traffic
- Competitor keyword overlap

5. AI Tools (ChatGPT / Claude)

Use AI tools to:

- Synthesize research
- Identify patterns
- Generate hypotheses
- Summarize insights

Important. AI should **support analysis, not replace it.**

Final Deliverables

1. Market Intelligence Report (PDF)

Sections should include:

- Company overview
- Product analysis
- Digital strategy
- Product ecosystem and growth signals
- Market segment overview
- Strategic insights
- Product recommendations

2. Presentation

A **short presentation** covering:

- Company overview
- Product strategy
- Digital strategy
- Market segment
- Strategic insights
- Product recommendations

Evaluation Criteria

Criteria	Weight
Depth of Company Analysis	30%
Use of Digital Intelligence Tools	20%
Quality of Strategic Insights	20%
Product Manager Recommendations	15%
Clarity of Report & Presentation	15%

Tips for a Strong Report

Avoid

- Generic AI summaries
- Copying website descriptions
- Focusing only on surface-level information

Focus on

- **Product strategy**
- **Market positioning**
- **Data-supported insights**
- **Clear product implications**

Remember. The goal is not to describe a company — it is to **understand how the company builds, positions, and grows its product in the market.**